

Abdal and participated in an online group 'Abdalians'. Both have been accused of providing "material support and resources for terrorist acts outside the US".

In Mumbai, Headley ran a small visa consultation firm from an office in South Mumbai's Tardeo area, not far from the Breach Candy flat where he stayed as a paying guest. He even employed a receptionist but did not fit the profile of a globe-trotting businessman; he didn't carry a phone and was evidently uncomfortable using the Internet in his office. He is said to have stayed at the Taj twice in the first half of 2007, but the evidence linking him to the 26/11 attacks is thus far purely circumstantial. But why was Headley visiting cities like Mumbai, Pune, Kochi and Goa? One line of investigation the NIA is pursuing has to do with the LeT setting up sleeper cells in these cities for future terror attacks.

As fresh revelations emerge in the case, there are indications that the trail of 26/11 may well lead to state actors in Pakistan. What has lent credence to this is that the duo was in touch with the Pakistan consul general in Chicago, Dr Aman Rashid, and that Rana's two brothers are serving officers of the Pakistan Army. The 26/11 terror attack intercepts provided to India by the US agencies did mention a serving Pakistani army officer, which may well be the missing link in the plot. Two other names figure in the criminal complaint. One is referred to as Individual A, "whose identity is known to the government, is an individual with substantial influence and responsibility within the LeT". Indian intelligence agencies believe this man to be an LeT operative Syed Abdur Rahman and the other is Ilyas Kashmiri, a former Special Services Group commando whom the FBI has described "as the operational chief of the Azad Kashmir section of Harakat-ul-Jihad-Islami (HUJI) with links to Al-Qaeda". The FBI complaints read like the first draft of a 'B' grade Hollywood thriller with all the stereotypes about the shadowy world of Islamist terror groups fronted by dodgy



First World Immigration Services.

Less than four months ago, the Denmark plan, was forsaken by the LeT for potential new attacks on India. In an e-mail on July 8, 2009, Headley first mentions "Rahul", who eventually turned out to be filmmaker Mahesh Bhatt's son Rahul Bhatt.

"I think when we get a chance, we should revisit our last location and meet Rahul". The complaint says, "LeT Member A replied to the above e-mail on July 8, 2009, and told Headley in an e-mail that 'to see Rahul is a good idea coz have some work for you over there too. Matters are good enough to move forward'." On July 9, 2009, Headley responded: "When you say move forward, do you mean in the north or towards Rahul?"

On the same day, LeT Member A responded that 'I mean towards Rahul', the complaint says. Although going by the chronology in the FBI complaint, Headley's interest in Indian targets appears to have been aroused only early this

year, the fact that he had been visiting India since 2007 would seem to suggest something else. Asked if that was angle that the FBI or the US Attorney's Northern Illinois district office was pursuing, Assistant US Attorney and Public Information Officer Randall Samborn told INDIA TODAY, "I would not be able to comment on anything beyond the contents of the complaint."

Related to the question of Headley's India visit is Rana's travel to the country as well. According to Vishvas Sapkal,

TRANSCRIPTS OF E-MAILS AND PHONE taps show Rana and Headley plotting fresh mass casualty terror attacks in India.

ethnic characters.

"In late 2008, Headley corresponded with Individual B and LeT Member A regarding what they referred to in coded communications as the 'Mickey Mouse Project' and 'the northern project', which involved attacking the offices of *Jyllands-Posten*, a Danish newspaper which in 2005 had published cartoons depicting the Prophet Muhammed," the complaint says. It says as part of the plot, Headley travelled to Denmark posing as an employee of Rana's company,